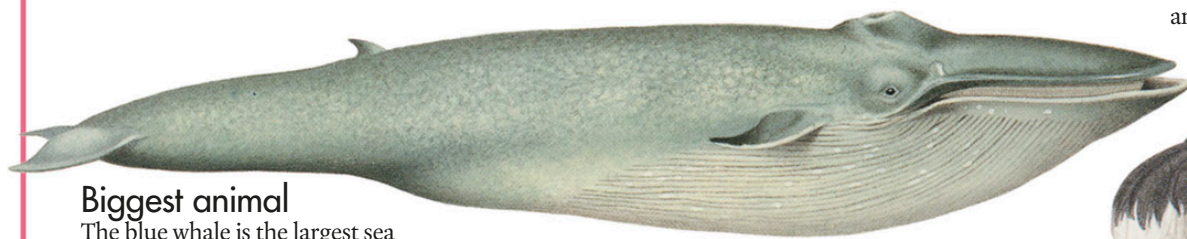


# Amazing Animals



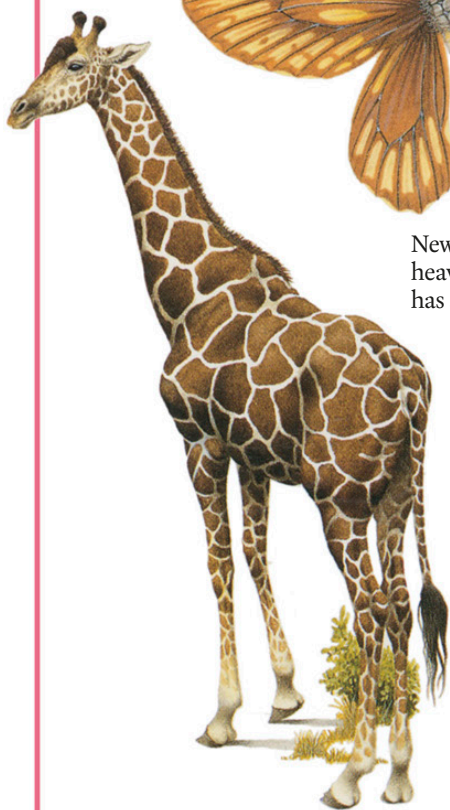
## Biggest animal

The blue whale is the largest sea mammal and the biggest animal that has ever lived on Earth. An adult can weigh up to 147 tons (150 tonnes).



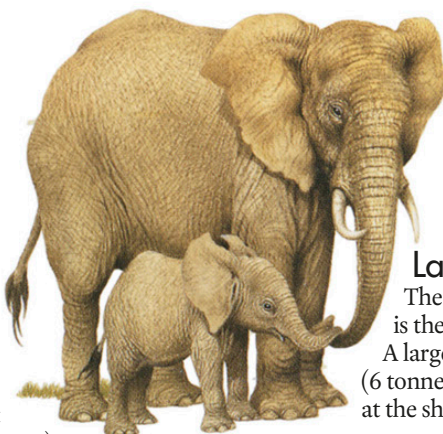
## Royal giant

The Queen Alexandra's birdwing butterfly of Papua New Guinea is the largest and heaviest butterfly in the world. It has a wingspan of up to 9.8 in (25 cm).



## Skyscraper neck

The giraffe towers up to 19 ft 4 in (5.9 m) above the African grasslands. Yet its incredible long neck contains only seven vertebrae—the same as all other mammals.



## Largest on land

The African savannah elephant is the world's largest land animal. A large male weighs about 5.9 tons (6 tonnes) and is 13 ft 1 in (4 m) tall at the shoulder.

## Biggest bird

The African ostrich is the largest bird in the world. Males can be up to 9 ft 2 in (2.8 m) tall and weigh 345 lb (156 kg). Ostriches are also the fastest two-legged animals, running at speeds of up to 45 mph (72 kph).



## Longest wings

The wandering albatross has the largest wingspan of any living bird. Its wings can measure over 11 ft 6 in (3.5 m) from one tip to the other. This albatross sometimes flies 560 miles (900 km) in a day.



## Long tail

The quetzal of Central America has huge tail feathers that are more than twice the length of his body. He uses them to attract a mate, and sheds them after mating season.



## Heaviest insect

The Goliath beetle weighs up to 3.5 oz (100 g) and is the heaviest living insect.



## Smallest bird

The Cuban bee hummingbird is the smallest bird in the world. An adult male is only 2 in (6 cm) long; half of its length is taken up by its bill and tail.



## Fastest flyer

The peregrine falcon is the fastest living creature, reaching speeds of at least 112 mph (180 kph) when it dives through the air in pursuit of its prey.

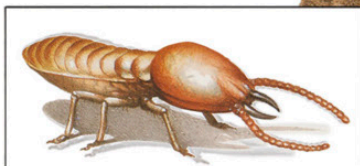
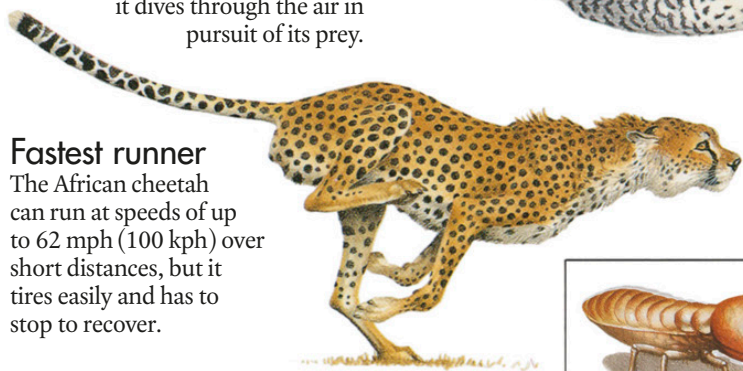
## Smallest mammal

Thailand's rare Kitti's hog-nosed bat is the joint holder of the record for smallest land mammal. It has a wingspan of only 6 in (15 cm) and weighs no more than 0.07 oz (2 g).



## Fastest runner

The African cheetah can run at speeds of up to 62 mph (100 kph) over short distances, but it tires easily and has to stop to recover.

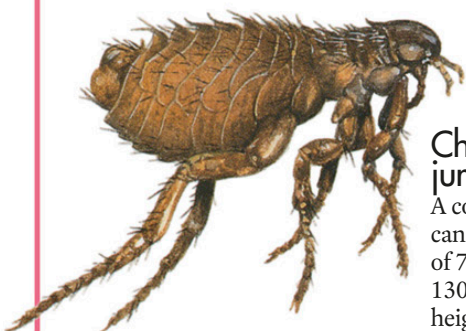


## Huge homes

Some African termites build tall, narrow nests over 26 ft (8 m) high. One may contain up to 5 million termites.

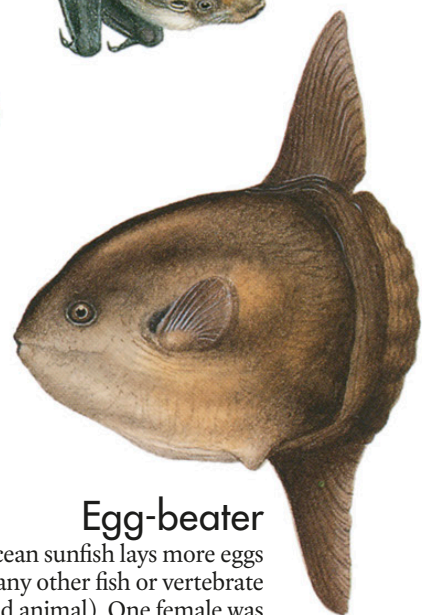
## Champion jumper

A common flea can do a high jump of 7.7 in (19 cm), 130 times its own height. It can do a long jump of 13 in (33 cm).



## Slow mover

The South American three-toed sloth moves along the ground at speeds of only 6 ft 6 in (2 m) a minute. In the trees it is a little faster, reaching a top speed of about 10 ft (3 m) a minute.



## Egg-beater

The ocean sunfish lays more eggs than any other fish or vertebrate (back-boned animal). One female was found to be carrying 300 million eggs.